

Directory

Franz Krommer

1759–1831, CZECH

In his day sometimes ranked with Beethoven, Krommer (also known as František Kramář) is noted for his writing for wind instruments and his numerous string quartets. Born in Kamenice, Moravia, then a part of the Austrian Empire, now in the Czech Republic, he studied violin and organ with his uncle, who was a choirmaster. His talents as an instrumentalist and composer earned him various musical posts at ducal courts and cathedrals. His compositions, appearing from the early 1790s, were chiefly influenced by Haydn and Mozart. In the early 1800s, he responded to demand for wind music by producing notable clarinet concertos and a series of partitas for wind bands. From 1811, he was associated with the Austrian imperial court, attaining the prestigious post of court composer in 1818. Krommer was prolific in his output, writing 77 string quartets, some of them strikingly innovative, as well as at least nine symphonies.

KEY WORKS: Symphony No. 1 in F major, Op. 12, 1797;